



>>Gautam Rege,
Co-Founder, Josh
Software>>

>>We sit down with Mr. Rege to learn about their new initiative towards increasing open source contribution from the community.>

Digit: What is CodeCuriosity and what are the reasons behind its inception?

Gautam: Open-source is being used everywhere today, if you're using an Android phone then you're probably using some Open-source component. Even if you look at applications made on the iPhone, they're probably using some open source library at the core. Microsoft open sourced .NET, Apple open sourced Swift 2, these are the languages and frameworks prevalently used to make applications. These large companies are moving towards open source. So open source has become a very common aspect today. Now, moving towards

the developer side, how many people consume open source and how many people contribute to open source? About 99.3 per cent consume open source and maybe less than 0.7 per cent – I'm being optimistic here – are actively contributing back.

Now this is a problem that we're trying to solve. So the roots of CodeCuriosity started off about 3-4 years ago at Josh when we wanted our team to start contributing back to open source. We were finding it difficult for them to get out of their daily grind to contribute. Majority of them did it as an optional thing. So after years of experimenting, we had something called Open Source Friday where nobody worked on their daily work and just contributed to open source projects. It worked for some months before dying down.

We started brainstorming to figure out that if open source contributions are fun, motivating and rewarding, then we had a solution. We started a competition. And if participants were found to be among the top 5-6 people then they were rewarded. We tried this internally at Josh for the last one year and we got astounding results.

Once we started tracking people's activities on GitHub, we were able to reward people for their work. And once we started doing that, we saw contributions increase. So we set up a platform and called it CodeCuriosity to track open source contributions. And through this platform, we were tracking every activity that was being done every day. And we were rewarding users.

We wanted it to be motivative and not competitive. So we started working towards the Fitbit model. Everyone knows running is healthy but it was only after wearables came into the picture and started telling you how much you've benefitted that you started getting motivated to run more.

CodeCuriosity does that for you. We set up goals, you can choose goals and then you start contributing on a monthly basis. The platform tells you how much you have contributed, how much is left for your target and when you do hit your targets, you are rewarded.

Digit: So how do you score a user?

Gautam: We have an automated algorithm which is open source and continues to evolve based on feedback. We try to improve and try to score every open source contributions – it could be a code commit, or raising an issue, etc. We've also been trying to integrate Stack-Exchange into CodeCuriosity.

So once you're able to track all these activities, you get rewarded points. And 10 points = \$1, so you can actually start making money out of your open source contributions. So not only are you making it fun, motivational and rewarding but you're also getting people to contribute back. So open source contributions become part of your daily routine. This is our aim. To ensure that we can tilt the balance of consumers:contributors from 99.3:0.7 to 95:5. Even if we are able to convert 10% of the consumers into contributors, the results will be astounding. Because the benefits are huge! >

*Nodes of Interest



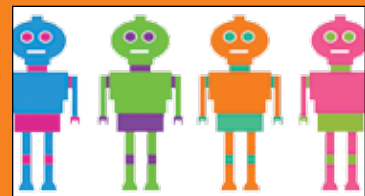
*Android Things : Getting started

>> Android Things is a new IoT platform based on Android OS.
<http://dgit.in/AndrdIoT>



*Minecraft Designer | Code

>> You can learn basic coding and make your own Minecraft game.
<http://dgit.in/MSmncrft>



*Botnet setup for Noobs

>>A step by step tutorial on how to setup your own botnet, without being an expert hacker yourself.
<http://dgit.in/BotnetForNoobs>